

PREPARATION PLAN · REVISED

Year 7 Maths Entrance Examination

Fifteen sessions, one hour a week, from late September to the exam on Saturday 16 January. Built entirely from real, sourced exam papers and topic worksheets — nothing in this plan is a question I invented. Includes the resource pack, the week-by-week scheme of work, what gets sent home and when, and the exam-week protocol.

EXAM	LENGTH	CALCULATOR	SESSIONS	HOME PRACTICE
Sat 16 Jan	50 minutes	Not permitted	15 × 1 hour	20 min × 5 days

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What changed in this revision

Every practice question is now sourced, not invented. The diagnostic, the mocks, and every week's home practice point to a real, named, freely available paper or worksheet set — official KS2 SATs papers, independent-school specimen papers with their own mark schemes, and topic-by-topic worksheets from Corbettmaths Primary. I am not qualified to certify that a question I wrote myself sits precisely at National Curriculum level 4 or 5; a published SATs paper or school specimen paper already carries that guarantee. Appendix A lists every source with a direct link.

The timing is looser. The old minute-by-minute run sheet for each hour has gone. Section 4 now describes four loose phases with rough proportions, not a stopwatch schedule, because a rigid nine-part hour is not how a ten-year-old's attention actually works.

SECTION 1

The exam, and what it is really testing

Read the specification closely and the content list is unremarkable. Everything named sits inside the Year 5 and Year 6 curriculum. The difficulty is not in the topics.

The exam is 50 minutes, split into a multiple choice section worth about 40 per cent of the marks and a written section worth about 60 per cent. No calculator. The content spans four strands: Number, Algebra, Shape, Handling Data.

Three features of that design decide how the preparation should work.

It is an arithmetic test wearing four different hats

Remove the calculator and almost every question, whatever strand it sits in, ends in a piece of mental or written arithmetic. Area of a triangle is one multiplication and one halving. Percentage of an amount is a division and a multiplication. Mean is an addition and a division. A child who is secure on method but slow or inaccurate with number will lose marks across all four strands at once, and the mark scheme will make those look like four separate weaknesses when they are one.

This is why arithmetic fluency, not topic coverage, is the spine of the plan.

Fifty minutes is short

Fifty minutes across two sections means the child cannot afford to stall. Most candidates at this level lose more marks to unfinished papers and careless slips than to topics they have never met. Pace is a trainable skill and it is trained by repeated timed exposure, not by being told to work faster.

Multiple choice is a different exam from written answers

Section A rewards speed, estimation, elimination and working backwards from the options. Section B rewards laid-out method, because method marks exist there and nowhere else. These need separating and practising as two distinct skills. A child drilled only on written method will be slow in Section A. A child drilled only on multiple choice will write bare answers in Section B and lose the method marks.

What the plan therefore prioritises, in order

1. Arithmetic accuracy and speed without a calculator
2. Fractions, decimals, percentages and ratio, which carry the heaviest mark load in Number
3. Timed exam exposure, starting early and repeating often
4. Area, perimeter, angles and averages, which are high yield and quick to secure
5. Algebra and chart interpretation, which are narrow at this level and can be taught late

SECTION 2

How this plan is built

1. Every question comes from somewhere real

Nothing in this plan is a maths question I made up. The diagnostic, the mocks and the weekly practice are all real, published material: official Key Stage 2 SATs papers, independent-school 11+ specimen papers with their own official mark schemes, and topic worksheets from an established primary maths resource. Each of these is calibrated by people whose job that is, marked against a scheme I did not write, and pitched at exactly the level the school's own specification describes. I write the teaching, the sequencing and the technique. I do not write the questions.

2. The hour teaches. The week practises.

Fifteen hours of tuition between now and January is not enough on its own. Twenty minutes a day, five days a week, over sixteen weeks is roughly twenty-six hours of additional practice. The home practice is where fluency is built. The lesson is where method is taught, errors are diagnosed and technique is rehearsed. If the lesson is spent on drill that could have happened at home, the hour has been wasted.

3. Diagnose before teaching anything.

Session 1 is a full baseline, not an introduction. Without it the topic order is guesswork, and with one hour a week there is no room for guesswork. The diagnostic in Section 6 uses a real past paper and is designed to produce a per-strand picture, not a single mark, so the output is a priority list rather than a grade.

4. Space the retrieval.

A topic taught in week three and never revisited is gone by January. Every home practice week includes retrieval pulling from earlier topics, and every lesson opens with a quick recap of something from a previous week. Nothing is taught once.

5. Build up to exam conditions gradually, not all at once.

Full timed papers come later in the term, once the content is in place. Early sessions are untimed and low-pressure, so the child is learning maths rather than learning to feel anxious about a clock. Timing is introduced in stages: first just noticing how long something takes, then a single timed question, then a full paper, well before January.

6. Work from errors, not from topics.

After Session 1, what gets taught is decided by what the child actually gets wrong, logged in the error book and re-tested on a schedule. The scheme of work in Section 7 is the default order. The error book overrides it.

What this plan deliberately does not do

- **It does not cover Year 7 or Year 8 content.** The specification is explicit that the paper sits at National Curriculum levels 4 and 5. Teaching beyond that buys nothing and costs confidence.
- **It does not increase the volume of home practice as January approaches.** Twenty minutes a day is the whole term. Volume spikes in the final fortnight produce fatigue, not marks.
- **It does not use a calculator at any point,** including for checking. The exam does not, so the preparation does not.
- **It does not run the child through a fixed minute-by-minute schedule every week.** See Section 4.

SECTION 3

The calendar

Fifteen weekly sessions from the week commencing 21 September to the week of the exam, with a two-week break over Christmas. Dates are shown as the week commencing, so the fixed weekly slot can sit anywhere in that week.

NO.	WEEK COMMENCING	FOCUS	ASSESSMENT
1	Mon 21 Sep	Baseline diagnostic and priority setting	Full diagnostic
2	Mon 28 Sep	Four operations, written methods, rounding, order of operations	Times tables check
3	Mon 5 Oct	Place value, decimals, negative numbers	
4	Mon 12 Oct	Factors, multiples, primes, square numbers	
5	Mon 19 Oct	Fractions: equivalence, simplifying, of an amount, add and subtract	
6	Mon 26 Oct (half term)	Percentages, and the fraction to decimal to percentage triangle	
7	Mon 2 Nov	Ratio and proportion	Timed practice: Number topics
8	Mon 9 Nov	Perimeter and area: rectangle, triangle, parallelogram, compound	
9	Mon 16 Nov	Angles, symmetry, properties of shapes, metric units	
10	Mon 23 Nov	Mean, median, mode, range	Timed practice: Shape and Data
11	Mon 30 Nov	Bar charts, pie charts, real-life graphs	
12	Mon 7 Dec	Coordinates, sequences, formulae, inverse operations	
13	Mon 14 Dec	Mock 1 sat and marked in the session, then repair	Mock 1, full 50 min
	21 Dec & 28 Dec	Christmas break. Light touch only: a few 5-a-day sets across the fortnight, plus Mock 2 sat at home on Tue 29 Dec.	Mock 2, at home
14	Mon 4 Jan	Mock 2 repair, then multiple choice speed intensive	
15	Mon 11 Jan	Mock 3 repair, final ten facts, exam protocol	Mock 3, at home Sat 9 Jan

Two scheduling notes

Half term, week commencing 26 Oct. I would keep the session. A free weekday morning is the best slot of the term and percentages is a topic worth full attention. If the family is away, move Session 6 into the Christmas fortnight rather than dropping it.

The Christmas fortnight. If one extra session can be added in the week commencing 28 Dec, the best use of it is to sit and mark Mock 2 together rather than having it marked at home. That is the single highest-value addition available to this plan.

Where Session 15 sits in exam week

The exam is Saturday 16 January. Hold Session 15 on Tuesday 12 or Wednesday 13 January, not Thursday or Friday. The last two days before the paper are for rest and light review, not for new work or for discovering a weakness with no time left to fix it.

SECTION 4

The session, not the stopwatch

The child is ten. An hour built as a rigid nine-part, minute-timed sequence is a plan for an adult sitting an exam, not a plan for a child learning one. What follows is a loose shape, not a schedule, and it moves at the pace the session actually needs.

Every session has the same four phases, roughly in this order, with no clock on the table except when a phase specifically calls for one. The proportions below are a guide for me, not an instruction read aloud to the child.

ROUGHLY	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS
First 5–10 min	Warm up	Quick-fire recall, no pressure, done out loud: times tables, a couple of number bonds, one or two questions from a previous week. The point is to arrive, not to perform.
Next 25–35 min	The main topic	Worked example together, then the child tries similar ones with me watching the working, not just the answer. This is the bulk of the hour and it stretches or shrinks depending on how the topic is landing. If focus is dropping, we stand up, stretch, or switch to something hands-on for a minute rather than pushing through.
Last 10–15 min	Trying it exam-style	A handful of questions from that week's real worksheet or paper, done the way the exam will ask for it — written out properly, or multiple choice without seeing the options first. Only from around Session 5 onward does this occasionally include a short timed burst, and even then it is two or three questions, not a full timed block. See Section 12 for how timing is introduced gradually across the term.
Last few min	Handover	What went well, what to send home, and one thing to tell Mum or explain back to her by the end of the week.

Three rules for the hour

- **The child holds the pen.** If I am writing and they are watching, they are not learning the method, they are watching me remember it.
- **A wrong answer gets talked through before it gets corrected.** The wrong answer usually contains the misconception, and that is the thing worth treating.
- **If the child is tired, flat, or it has been a long school day, the hour bends.** Less new content, more of what they already find satisfying, and we pick the thread back up next week. One quiet hour costs nothing over a sixteen-week term. A child who starts dreading Tuesdays costs a great deal.

Why there is no minute-by-minute schedule

A fixed sequence of seven or eight timed sub-blocks assumes an attention span and a tolerance for being timed that most ten-year-olds do not have, especially at the end of a school day. It also removes my judgement from the one variable that actually matters in the room: how the child is doing today. The four phases above give the session a shape without pretending an hour with a child runs like an exam.

Online or in person

If sessions run online, I need to see the page as it is being written, not just hear it talked through — a second device or a phone propped over the paper works well. Everything else about the hour is unchanged.

SECTION 5

Where every question comes from: the resource pack

This is the section that changed most in this revision. Rather than writing my own diagnostic and practice questions and asking you to trust my sense of where level 4 and 5 sit, every question, worksheet and paper in this plan is a real, existing, freely available resource, made by people whose job is exactly that calibration. This section explains the four sources and how they map onto the plan. Appendix A is the full link index.

SOURCE	WHAT IT GIVES	USED FOR
Corbettmaths Primary corbettmathsprimary.com	Free video, worksheet and answer sheet for around 76 primary topics, plus a daily “5-a-day” at four difficulty tiers (Bronze to Platinum) and Study Cards.	The backbone of weekly home practice. Every topic in the scheme of work in Section 7 has a matching Corbettmaths worksheet. Answers are provided separately, so a parent marks without me needing to send a key.
Key Stage 2 SATs papers gov.uk, official	The real Year 6 national test: Paper 1 Arithmetic (30 min, no calculator) and Papers 2–3 Reasoning (40 min each, no calculator), with official mark schemes. This is the modern equivalent of the “level 4 and 5” standard the school’s own specification names. The most recent three years are on gov.uk directly; earlier years back to 2016 are mirrored by established sites.	The baseline diagnostic in Section 6, and one of the three mocks. Genuinely calibrated to the exact standard this exam is pitched at.
Independent school 11+ specimen papers school websites, published for applicants	Several independent schools publish their own Year 7 entrance maths specimen papers with mark schemes, for exactly this kind of preparation. Dulwich College publishes six full specimen papers (A–F), each one hour, no calculator, 100 marks, each with an official mark scheme — the closest free match in both format and level to the paper this plan is preparing for.	The other two mocks, and extra material if a topic needs more timed practice than the SATs papers alone provide.
Times tables and number facts	Pure recall — times tables, number bonds, doubles and halves.	The warm-up phase of every session (Section 4) and the daily facts habit in home practice (Section 8).

SOURCE	WHAT IT GIVES	USED FOR
self-quizzed, or Corbettmaths Times Tables	This is the one category of “question” that does not need sourcing from a calibrated paper, because it is not exam-style content to calibrate. It is facts, and facts are either known or not.	

What this means in practice

When Section 7 says “home practice: Corbettmaths – Simplifying Fractions,” that is a real, printable worksheet with its own answer sheet, made by an established maths teacher for exactly this age and stage. When Section 6 says “sit the 2024 KS2 Arithmetic paper,” that is the actual test every Year 6 pupil in the country sat that May, with a government-published mark scheme. I compile the specific pages needed each week into a single printable pack, so a parent is never hunting across three websites — see Section 8 for exactly what gets sent and when.

One honest limit

I cannot republish someone else's copyrighted worksheet or exam paper as my own document. What I can and do send is a short covering sheet I write myself — instructions, the answer key location, what to focus on — alongside a direct link or a printed copy of the real source material, used under the free, personal-use terms those sites themselves offer. Appendix A gives the exact links so you always know where material came from.

SECTION 6

Session 1: the baseline diagnostic

The diagnostic is a real Key Stage 2 SATs paper, sat and marked against its own official scheme. It is spread across the sitting and Session 1 itself, rather than crammed into one hour, because the actual papers are 30 and 40 minutes long and a diagnostic should not feel like a race.

WHEN	WHAT	HOW
Before Session 1, at home	KS2 Paper 1: Arithmetic	30 minutes, one sitting, no calculator, no help. A recent-but-not-latest year, so the freshest papers are saved for later mocks. Sent home, marked by a parent from the official mark scheme, and brought to Session 1.
Session 1, first 20 min	Review the arithmetic paper	We go through it together: which questions were wrong, and — more useful than the mark — what the working shows about how each wrong answer was reached.
Session 1, next 25 min	A selection from KS2 Paper 2 or 3: Reasoning	Around 12–15 questions chosen from a reasoning paper, spanning Number, Shape, Algebra and Data. Done at a relaxed pace, not against a clock — this is the one sitting in the whole term where timing is deliberately switched off, because the point is to see what the child can do, not how fast.
Session 1, last 15 min	Talk it through	Two or three of the wrong answers, explained aloud by the child. This is where a misconception actually surfaces — a wrong answer on its own rarely says enough.

Tell the child beforehand that this is not a test to fail, that it is how I work out what to spend the term on, and that leaving a question blank tells me more than a guessed answer does. That instruction is the opposite of exam advice and applies only to this one sitting.

Building the strand grid

Official KS2 mark schemes list which part of the curriculum each question is drawn from, so I use that — not my own judgement — to sort the marks into Number, Shape, Algebra and Handling Data. I fill this grid in after Session 1 and send it with the first week's home practice.

STRAND	MARKS AVAILABLE	SCORE	%	WHAT THAT MEANS FOR THE ORDER IN SECTION 7
Number				
Shape				
Algebra				
Handling data				
Arithmetic paper, overall				

How I read the result

The arithmetic paper. This is the clearest fluency signal in the whole diagnostic, because it is exactly the kind of non-calculator arithmetic the real exam needs throughout. A strong score there means fluency is not the constraint and the scheme of work runs roughly as written. A weak score means the daily facts practice in Section 8 matters more than any single topic, and one or two teaching sessions may compress to make room for it.

Any strand in the reasoning selection. Roughly under half correct: teach that strand from the beginning, allow extra time. Roughly half to three quarters: one session to consolidate, then it comes back through retrieval only.

Comfortably secure: no dedicated teaching session, just a retrieval question here and there, and the freed time goes to a weaker strand.

SECTION 7

Scheme of work, session by session

Sessions 2 to 12 run on the loose shape from Section 4. What changes each week is the topic. Sessions 13, 14 and 15 are built around the three mocks. The order below is the default and is rewritten at the end of Session 1 against the strand grid. Every home practice line below names a real Corbettmaths Primary worksheet — the direct links are in Appendix A, organised in the same order as this scheme.

Session 2

W/C 28 SEP · NUMBER

Written methods for all four operations, rounding, and order of operations.

Teach: column addition and subtraction including decimals of unequal length and exchanging across zeros; short multiplication; two-digit by two-digit multiplication; short division including remainders expressed as decimals; rounding to 10, 100, 1,000 and one decimal place; brackets, then multiply and divide, then add and subtract.

Errors to pre-empt: decimal points not aligned; 5,002 minus 1,438 style exchanging; remainders left as r 3 when a decimal is wanted; working left to right through a mixed operation string.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Column Addition & Subtraction, Short Multiplication, Short Division, Order of Operations, Rounding (one or two of these across the week, not all five). Plus daily times tables. **Explain back by Friday:** why you line up the decimal points.

Session 3

W/C 5 OCT · NUMBER

Place value, decimals, and negative numbers.

Teach: multiplying and dividing by 10, 100 and 1,000 as digits moving rather than the point moving; ordering decimals of unequal length; adding and subtracting negatives on a number line; temperature and difference problems.

Errors to pre-empt: 0.7 judged smaller than 0.35 because it has fewer digits; minus 6 plus 9 treated as minus 15; the difference between minus 3 and 5 given as 2.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Multiplying/Dividing by 10, 100, 1000, Ordering Decimals, Negative Numbers. Plus a couple of Session 2 questions from the error book. **Explain back:** how to tell which of two decimals is larger.

Session 4

W/C 12 OCT · NUMBER

Factors, multiples, primes, square numbers.

Teach: listing factors in pairs so none are missed; multiples and lowest common multiple; highest common factor, which is the tool fractions will need next week; primes up to 50 and why 1 is not one; square numbers to 144 and their roots.

Errors to pre-empt: factors and multiples used interchangeably; 1 and the number itself omitted from a factor list; 51 and 91 assumed prime.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Factors, Multiples, Prime Numbers, Square & Cube Numbers. **Explain back:** the difference between a factor and a multiple, in one sentence each.

Sessions 5 to 7

Session 5

W/C 19 OCT · NUMBER

Fractions: equivalence, simplifying, of an amount, adding and subtracting.

Teach: equivalent fractions; simplifying fully using the highest common factor from last week; improper fractions and mixed numbers both ways; fraction of an amount as divide by the bottom, multiply by the top; adding and subtracting with a common denominator.

Errors to pre-empt: stopping after one simplification step; adding denominators; dividing and forgetting to multiply.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Equivalent Fractions, Simplifying Fractions, Fraction of an Amount, Adding & Subtracting Fractions. **Explain back:** how to find three eighths of 64 without a calculator.

Session 6

W/C 26 OCT · NUMBER · HALF TERM

Percentages, and moving between fractions, decimals and percentages.

Teach: the non-calculator toolkit — 50% by halving, 25% by quartering, 10% by dividing by ten, 5% as half of 10%, 1% by dividing by a hundred, building everything else by combining those; percentage of an amount; percentage increase and decrease; the conversions worth knowing cold: a half, a quarter, three quarters, a fifth, two fifths, a tenth, a third.

Errors to pre-empt: finding the reduction and giving it as the sale price; 15% found by halving 30%; a third written as 0.3.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Percentage of an Amount, Fractions Decimals Percentages (conversions). **Explain back:** three different ways to find 15% of a number without a calculator.

Session 7

W/C 2 NOV · NUMBER · TIMED PRACTICE

Ratio and proportion, then a first go at working against a clock.

Teach: ratio notation; total parts, one part, then scale; sharing an amount in a ratio; scaling a recipe up and down; the unitary method.

Timed practice: a short, mixed set drawn from Sessions 2–7 topics — Corbettmaths worksheets already covered, redone against a gentle time target, roughly 20 minutes. The first time timing appears at all this term. We talk about what it felt like, not just the score.

Errors to pre-empt: treating 2:3 as two thirds; giving the wrong person's share; scaling by adding rather than multiplying.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Ratio, Sharing in a Ratio. Plus whatever the timed practice flagged. **Explain back:** how you know which share belongs to whom.

Sessions 8 to 10

Session 8

W/C 9 NOV · SHAPE

Perimeter and area of rectangles, triangles, parallelograms and compound shapes.

Teach: perimeter as distance round and area as space inside, established once and returned to every time; rectangle; triangle as half base times perpendicular height; parallelogram as base times perpendicular height, and why it is not the slanted side; compound shapes by splitting and by subtracting.

Errors to pre-empt: area calculated when perimeter is asked for; the halving forgotten in a triangle; the slant side used as the height of a parallelogram; units given as cm rather than cm squared.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Area of a Rectangle, Area of a Triangle, Area of a Parallelogram, Perimeter. **Explain back:** why the height of a parallelogram is not the sloping side.

Session 9

W/C 16 NOV · SHAPE

Angles, symmetry, properties of shapes, metric units.

Teach: angles on a straight line summing to 180, at a point to 360, in a triangle to 180; isosceles and equilateral triangles; lines of symmetry; metric conversion between mm, cm, m and km, between g and kg, and between ml and l.

Errors to pre-empt: the two base angles of an isosceles triangle not recognised as equal; 2.5 kg converted to 250 g; a scale read as though every division is one unit.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Angles in a Triangle, Angle Facts, Symmetry, Metric Units. **Explain back:** the three angle facts, from memory, without prompting.

Session 10

W/C 23 NOV · DATA · TIMED PRACTICE

Mean, median, mode and range, then a second go at working against a clock.

Teach: mean as total divided by how many; median with the list ordered first; mode including no mode and two modes; range as largest minus smallest.

Timed practice: a mixed set from the Shape and Data worksheets covered so far, again against a gentle time target rather than the real exam pace.

Errors to pre-empt: median taken from the unordered list; mean and median swapped; range given as the largest value.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Mean, Median, Mode and Range (Averages). **Explain back:** the first thing you do before finding a median.

Sessions 11 and 12

Session 11

W/C 30 NOV · DATA

Bar charts, pie charts and real-life graphs.

Teach: reading a bar chart whose axis goes up in twos, fives or tens; pie charts read by fraction of the circle; conversion graphs read in both directions; reading between gridlines.

Errors to pre-empt: every gridline assumed to be one unit; a pie chart sector counted as a number of pupils rather than a proportion; a graph read in one direction only.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Bar Charts, Pie Charts, Reading Scales. **Explain back:** how to work out how many people one sector of a pie chart represents.

Session 12

W/C 7 DEC · ALGEBRA

Coordinates, sequences, formulae and inverse operations.

Teach: coordinates in all four quadrants; sequences by term-to-term rule, continuing them and deciding whether a given number appears; substituting into a formula with two operations; inverse operations used to work backwards from an answer.

Errors to pre-empt: x and y transposed; a negative coordinate read with the wrong sign; a two-operation formula evaluated left to right; an inverse chain undone in the wrong order.

Home practice. Corbettmaths – Coordinates, Sequences, Substitution. **Explain back:** how to check a coordinate is the right way round.

If the diagnostic reorders this

The likeliest reorderings, based on the Session 1 result: a weak arithmetic paper means Sessions 4 and 12 compress or move later, and the recovered time goes to daily facts practice and the four-operations work in Session 2. A strong Number strand means Sessions 2 and 3 compress into one and the spare week goes to an extra mock in November. Shape or Data noticeably weaker than Number means those sessions move earlier, ahead of ratio, because they are quick to secure and carry marks currently being given away.

Sessions 13 to 15, and the Christmas fortnight

Session 13

W/C 14 DEC · MOCK 1

The first full paper under exam conditions — a Dulwich College specimen paper, sat and largely marked in the session.

We set the room up like an exam — desk cleared, no interruptions — and the child sits the paper in one go. I watch for where time gets lost and where the child stalls, without stepping in. Afterwards we mark what we can together, and I take the rest away to mark fully against the paper's own scheme, back within a day or two with a short repair list — no more than five items, because a longer list gets ignored rather than acted on.

Home practice. The repair items, spread gently across the week rather than crammed into one sitting. Nothing new introduced this week.

Christmas

21 DEC TO 3 JAN · NO SESSIONS

A light-touch fortnight. The aim is to stop things slipping, not to make progress.

- A few short times-tables or 5-a-day sessions across the fortnight — ten minutes here and there, not a daily obligation.
- Mock 2, a KS2 SATs paper, sat at home on or around Tuesday 29 December under proper conditions: one sitting, no calculator, no help. Marked by a parent against the official mark scheme and photographed to me the same day.
- Otherwise, a real break. No worksheets, no apps, no revision guides.

If one extra session can be bought in the week commencing 28 December, use it to sit and mark Mock 2 together instead. That turns the highest-value assessment of the whole plan from a home exercise into a taught one.

Session 14

W/C 4 JAN · REPAIR AND MULTIPLE CHOICE PRACTICE

Fix what Mock 2 exposed, then spend focused time on multiple choice technique.

We group the Mock 2 errors by category rather than by question — categories are what generalise to new questions, individual questions do not. Once that is done, we work through a set of multiple choice questions using the approach in Section 10: cover the options, solve, then look. Towards the end of the session we agree the plan for Mock 3 on Saturday 9 January, including roughly what time of day it will happen.

Home practice. A couple of mixed retrieval sets. Mock 3 on Saturday 9 January, one sitting, marked and sent to me that day.

Session 15

TUE 12 OR WED 13 JAN · FINAL SESSION

Narrow the focus, walk through the exam-day plan, and finish on something the child gets right.

We look at Mock 3 and pick out two or three things worth a last look — not a long list. We go over the methods card in Appendix B and settle on the handful of facts still worth one more pass. Then some mixed questions, weighted toward things the child used to get wrong and now gets right, so the session ends on a good note rather than a hard one. We finish by reading through the exam-day plan in Section 17 together: what to bring, what the morning looks like, what to do if a question won't come.

Thursday 14 January: ten minutes with the methods card, nothing else. **Friday 15 January:** no maths.

SECTION 8

Home practice, and what goes to Mum

Most weekdays, not literally every single one, for around fifteen to twenty minutes. The consistency matters more than the exact minute count, and there is no daily stopwatch — that belongs in the exam, not in a kitchen table routine.

ROUGHLY	WHAT HAPPENS
Two or three days	A Corbettmaths worksheet on the topic taught that week — not the whole sheet if it is long, whatever fits in the time without a fight.
One day	Retrieval — a handful of questions from a couple of weeks ago, so nothing gets forgotten.
One day, from around Session 7 onward	A short exam-flavoured go: a few questions done properly, written out or multiple choice without seeing the options first. Not against a hard clock — see Section 12 for how timing builds up gradually across the term.

Why it is built this way

- **It flexes around the week.** A bad day at school, a late clubs night, a birthday party — the pack for the week has enough in it to skip a day without falling behind, not so much that missing a day feels like failure.
- **Retrieval every week.** Without this, September and October are gone by Christmas.
- **The exam-flavoured day builds up slowly.** By January, working through a few questions the exam way should feel ordinary rather than like a test within a test.
- **Fifteen to twenty minutes is a ceiling, not a target to beat.** If it is finished in ten, the day is done. Adding more is how children come to resent a subject in November, when there is still a term to go.

Marking

A parent marks it the same day from the Corbettmaths answer sheet, ticks and crosses only, no explanation offered and no re-teaching attempted. A cross gets circled and goes in the error book untouched. The reason for the no-re-teaching rule is not that parents cannot teach it — it is that a method explained differently from the one taught in the lesson leaves a child holding two half-methods, which is worse than holding one.

If the child is stuck and frustrated, the instruction is to stop, write the question number down, and move on. I would rather see the stuck question next session than sit through a tearful evening now.

The weekend

Free, except the two mock Saturdays, 9 January and any additional one agreed.

What I send Mum, and when

One message per week, sent the same day as the session, with one PDF attached. The PDF is a single-page covering sheet I write myself, followed by the real worksheet pages for that week's topic printed straight from Corbettmaths, with the answer sheet as the last page. Everything needed to print is in that one file — nothing to go hunting for.

SENT	MESSAGE	PDF ATTACHED
Before Session 1	What the diagnostic is, and the KS2 Arithmetic paper to print and sit before we meet.	The arithmetic paper, official mark scheme, and a one-line instruction sheet: 30 minutes, no calculator, no help.
Same evening, after every session (2–12)	One line: what we covered, how it went, what's in the pack.	That week's Corbettmaths worksheet(s), with the answer sheet as the last page, plus the retrieval questions for the week.

SENT	MESSAGE	PDF ATTACHED
Same evening, after Session 13 (Mock 1)	The headline from the mock — not the score in isolation, what it means — and the repair list.	The five repair items, one per day for the coming week.
Before Christmas	What the light-touch fortnight looks like, and the Mock 2 paper for 29 December.	Mock 2 paper, mark scheme, and the holiday instruction sheet.
Before Mock 3 (9 Jan)	Reminder of the conditions: one sitting, no help, send a photo the same day.	Mock 3 paper and mark scheme.
After Session 15	A short note: where things stand, what the final week looks like, and the exam-day logistics from Section 17.	The methods card (Appendix B) and the equipment checklist.

Nothing is ever sent as a bare link with “print pages 3 to 6.” Every pack is one PDF, titled clearly with the week and topic, ready to open and print. Appendix A has the full list of sources behind every pack, in case you ever want to see where something came from.

SECTION 9

The error book

One exercise book, used for nothing else. It is the single most important object in this plan, because it is what turns fifteen hours of tuition into a targeted fifteen hours rather than a generic fifteen.

What goes in it

Every question the child gets wrong, in a lesson, in home practice, in timed practice or in a mock. Nothing that was got right. One entry per error, four lines:

- Line 1.** The question, copied or stuck in.
- Line 2.** What I did.
- Line 3.** What I should have done.
- Line 4.** The rule, in one sentence, in the child's own words.

Line 2 is the one people skip and the one that matters. The wrong working is where the misconception lives. Line 4 has to be the child's sentence, not mine, because a rule they cannot phrase is a rule they have not got.

Re-testing

Each entry is dated and re-tested twice: seven days later and twenty-one days later, during that week's retrieval practice. A re-test that is correct both times gets the entry ruled through. A re-test that is wrong resets the clock and, if it happens twice, the topic goes into the next lesson's teaching block regardless of what the scheme of work says.

The category count

Every four weeks, count the entries by category rather than reading them. The categories that matter for this paper are: recall speed, written method slip, misread the question, method not known, method known but misapplied, units or labelling, and ran out of time. The distribution tells you what to fix, and it changes what to fix in a way that reading individual questions does not.

IF THE BIGGEST CATEGORY IS	THE RESPONSE IS
Recall speed	More daily facts practice, less teaching. Cut a topic from the scheme.
Written method slip	Slow the working down and insist on full layout. Accuracy before speed for two weeks.
Misread the question	Underline the command word and the units on every question, in every set, for a fortnight.
Method not known	Straightforward. Teach it. This is the easiest category to fix and the least worrying.
Method known but misapplied	The hardest one. Practise identifying which method a question wants, using sets of mixed questions where the child only says which method applies and does not solve them.
Units or labelling	A checking habit, not a maths problem. Build it into the last two minutes of every timed set.
Ran out of time	Section 12. Pacing, not content.

SECTION 10

Section A technique: multiple choice

Roughly 40 per cent of the marks. It is a different skill from the written section, and it is introduced gently from the middle of the term — not drilled hard from week one, and not left until January either.

The seven rules

1. **Cover the options. Solve. Then look.** Distractors are designed to match the specific errors a child is likely to make, so reading them first pulls you toward one. Working the answer out blind and then finding it in the list removes that pull entirely. This is the single most valuable habit in Section A.
2. **If your answer is not there, you have made an error, not found a printing mistake.** Go back and check the last operation first.
3. **Estimate before calculating on anything with decimals or large numbers.** An estimate usually eliminates two options in five seconds and catches place value errors that would otherwise be invisible.
4. **For find-the-value questions, substitute the options back in.** Four substitutions are often faster and safer than one rearrangement.
5. **Two passes.** First pass, answer everything that takes under 45 seconds and put a star beside anything that does not. Second pass, return to the starred ones with the time that is left. Never let one question eat four minutes on the first pass.
6. **Nothing is left blank.** On the second pass, eliminate what is impossible and choose from the rest. A one in three guess is worth more than an empty box, and there is no penalty for a wrong answer on papers of this type.
7. **Check the units and check it is sensible.** A perimeter answer in cm squared is wrong. A sale price higher than the original price is wrong. Ten seconds of sense-checking recovers more marks than ten seconds of extra calculation.

How this gets trained

From around Session 7, most sessions and most weeks' home practice include a handful of multiple choice questions done the "cover, solve, then look" way, drawn from that week's real worksheet or paper. A rough sense of pace — not a hard 45-second rule — gets introduced from around Session 10, and only becomes a real timer in Session 14's practice and the mocks. By January, working through multiple choice questions this way should feel familiar rather than like a new skill under pressure.

SECTION 11

Section B technique: written answers

Roughly 60 per cent of the marks, and the only place method marks exist. A child who writes bare answers here is throwing away marks they have already earned.

The six rules

1. **Write the calculation, not just the answer.** Even where the answer is obvious. On a four-mark question, two of those marks are usually for method, and a wrong final answer with correct working still scores. A right answer with no working can score full marks, but a wrong one with no working scores zero.
2. **Read the last line of the question first.** It tells you what is being asked, which tells you what to look for in the rest of it.
3. **Underline the command word and the units.** Find, calculate, explain, and how many all want different things. Explain means a sentence, and a number alone will not score.
4. **Units on every answer, every time.** Pounds, centimetres, centimetres squared, grams, degrees. This is free marks and it is lost constantly.
5. **Lay working out downward, not across the page.** One step per line. It is easier to check, easier to mark, and it is where the method marks are found.
6. **Answer the question that was asked.** If it asks for the sale price, do not stop at the discount. If it asks for Ben's share, do not give Ana's.

Explain questions

Questions asking why or how you know appear on papers of this kind and are routinely half-answered. The structure to drill is: state the answer, then give the mathematical reason, in one sentence. For B5(a)(iii) in the diagnostic, no on its own is half a mark's worth of thinking. No, because the terms go 43, 48, 53 and 51 is not among them, is the full answer. This gets practised from Session 2 through the explain-back task in every week's home practice.

The two-minute check at the end

If two minutes remain at the end of the paper, they are spent in this order, and not on re-doing questions. First, every blank filled in Section A. Second, units checked on every Section B answer. Third, any answer that is obviously unreasonable, a negative length, a percentage over a hundred, a sale price above the original, reconsidered. Re-working a question you already answered is almost always a worse use of two minutes than these three checks.

SECTION 12

Pacing the paper

Pacing is a skill and it is trainable, but it is only rehearsed on real timed sittings — the mocks in Section 13 and, before that, the two timed practice blocks in Sessions 7 and 10. It is never the shape of an ordinary week. Most marks lost at this level are lost to unfinished papers and rushed slips rather than to unknown topics.

The timing plan

The exact number of questions is not known until the specimen paper arrives, so this is provisional and gets confirmed then. Working from the published weighting of 40 per cent multiple choice and 60 per cent written:

BLOCK	TIME	RULE
Section A, pass 1	14 minutes	Everything that takes under 45 seconds. Star and skip the rest. Do not stop to finish a hard one.
Section A, pass 2	4 minutes	The starred questions. Eliminate and choose. Nothing left blank when this block ends.
Section B	29 minutes	In order. Any question that stalls for more than 90 seconds gets a star and gets left. Come back only if there is time.
Final check	3 minutes	Blanks, then units, then anything unreasonable. In that order.

The two checkpoints

Two glances at the clock in the whole paper, not continuous monitoring, which costs attention and raises anxiety without improving pace.

- **At 18 minutes.** Section A should be finished and Section B started. If Section A is not finished, choose from the remaining options immediately and move on. Section B carries more marks per question.
- **At 40 minutes.** Should be into the last quarter of Section B. If not, skip forward to any remaining short questions and pick up the easy marks before returning.

What to do when stuck

The instruction, rehearsed until it is automatic, is: read it once more, underline what it is asking, and if there is still nothing after fifteen seconds, star it and move on. The reason this needs rehearsing is that the instinct is the opposite. A child who is stuck usually stares harder, and a paper is lost three minutes at a time.

The one thing that must be finished is Section A. It is the fastest section and it is the one where a blank is guaranteed to score zero while a guess is not. If the paper is going badly, the correct response is to make sure every multiple choice box has a letter in it.

SECTION 13

The three mocks, and how to mark them

MOCK	WHEN	PAPER	PURPOSE
Mock 1	Session 13, w/c 14 Dec	Dulwich College Year 7 entrance specimen paper (one hour, no calculator, official mark scheme)	First full-length experience, sat in the session. I watch for where time gets lost rather than marking as we go.
Mock 2	Tue 29 Dec	A KS2 SATs paper (30–40 min, official mark scheme)	Tests whether things hold after a lighter fortnight, and rehearses sitting a paper somewhere other than with me.
Mock 3	Sat 9 Jan	A second Dulwich specimen paper, or the school's own specimen paper if it has arrived by then	Dress rehearsal, as close to exam morning conditions as we can get.

The school's own specimen paper, whenever it arrives, becomes an additional sitting, not a replacement for one of the three above — see Section 14. It is the one paper of the four that is certain to match the real one in style.

The Dulwich papers are timed at one hour rather than fifty minutes. For the first mock this does not matter — slightly more time to finish makes it a gentler introduction to a full paper. For Mock 3, closer to the real thing, we can simply stop at the fifty-minute mark and mark only what was reached by then.

Conditions, every time

- One sitting, no breaks, timer visible but not obsessed over.
- No calculator, no times tables square, no help of any kind.
- Pen or pencil, ruler, eraser. Nothing else on the desk.
- Started and finished in one go, even if it goes badly. Stopping halfway teaches the wrong thing.

Marking

Marked against the paper's own official scheme. Three things get recorded each time, not just the mark.

1. **The mark.** Useful mainly for the trend across three papers. A single mock score on its own means very little.
2. **Questions unattempted.** Recorded separately from questions wrong, because running out of time is a pacing problem and not a knowledge problem, and it has a completely different fix — see Section 12.
3. **Marks lost to slips.** Questions where the method was right and the arithmetic was not. If this number is high, the answer is more daily facts practice and slower, clearer written layout, not more topic teaching.

The repair list

Never more than five items, chosen by how many marks they are likely to be worth in January rather than by how badly they were done. A topic worth two marks that was got badly wrong comes below a topic worth eight marks that was half right. One item at a time over the following week, then the item goes into the error book re-test cycle.

On mock scores and morale

Mock 1 in mid-December will very likely be the lowest of the three, because it is the first full paper and the child will probably not finish it. Say this before the paper, not after. A child who is told in advance that the first mock is expected to be unfinished treats it as information. A child told afterwards treats it as consolation.

SECTION 14

When the specimen paper arrives

The school says a specimen paper will be sent to all Year 7 applicants. It is the most valuable single document in this whole process, and the plan should bend to it. Chase it if it has not arrived by the end of October.

The audit, twenty minutes, done by me before the next session

1. **Count the marks by strand.** Number, Algebra, Shape, Handling Data. Compare against the weighting this plan assumes and adjust the remaining sessions to match. If Shape turns out to be a fifth of the paper rather than a tenth, Session 9 grows.
2. **Count the questions and the marks in each section.** This converts the provisional timing plan in Section 12 into an exact one: minutes per question in Section A, and minutes per mark in Section B.
3. **Note the question styles, not just the topics.** Whether the written questions are single-step or multi-step, whether context-heavy word problems appear, whether explain questions appear and how many marks they carry, whether diagrams are given or have to be drawn.
4. **Note the level of the arithmetic.** Whether long multiplication of two two-digit numbers appears, whether division produces decimal answers, how large the numbers get. This tells me how hard the daily facts practice should be for the rest of the term.
5. **Note the layout.** Answer boxes, working space, whether multiple choice answers are circled or written in a grid. Small things, but a child meeting an unfamiliar answer format for the first time in the exam loses time to it.

Then

The child sits it under full conditions at the next available weekend, and the remaining scheme of work is rewritten against what the audit found. Any topic in this plan that does not appear anywhere in the specimen paper drops down the order. Any topic that appears twice moves up.

One caution. A specimen paper is one paper, not the syllabus. A topic listed in the school's published content but absent from the specimen still gets taught, just later. The specimen tells you about style and weighting with confidence, and about content only with caution.

SECTION 15

Triage: what to cut if time runs short

Sessions get cancelled, illness happens, and the diagnostic may show more ground to cover than fifteen hours allows. Decide the cutting order now, calmly, rather than in December.

Protected. Cut these last, whatever happens.

TOPIC	WHY IT IS PROTECTED
Arithmetic fluency	Every question in every strand ends in arithmetic. Weakness here costs marks four times over.
Fraction, percentage and ratio of an amount	The heaviest single mark load in Number, and the three are one method with three faces.
Area and perimeter of rectangles and triangles	High frequency, low difficulty, quick to secure. The best marks-per-minute in the whole plan.
Mean, median, mode, range	Four definitions. An afternoon's work for a reliable handful of marks.
Angles in a triangle and on a line	Two facts. Appears on almost every paper of this type.
Coordinates in four quadrants	Named explicitly in the school's content list, and takes twenty minutes to secure.
Section A technique and pacing	Worth more marks than any single topic, because it applies to the whole paper.

Cut first, in this order

1. **Position-to-term rules for sequences.** Term-to-term is enough for level 5. The general rule is a stretch topic here.
2. **Compound shapes of three or more parts.** Two-part compounds cover almost everything that appears.
3. **Pie chart construction and degree calculations.** The school's content list says interpreting pie charts. Interpreting by simple fraction covers most of it.
4. **Best value and complex unitary method.** Straightforward proportion is the requirement.
5. **Multiplying and dividing negative numbers.** Adding and subtracting negatives is the level 4 and 5 requirement. Multiplying is beyond it.
6. **Order of rotational symmetry.** Lines of symmetry are the common version.

The rule for a lost session

If a session is missed and cannot be rescheduled, do not compress two topics into the following hour. Cut one topic from the list above instead and keep the standard hour intact. A rushed double lesson teaches neither topic and costs the starter and the error review, which are the two blocks that make the rest work.

The parent page

This page can be printed on its own and handed over. Everything on it is a request, and every request has a reason attached, because instructions without reasons do not survive a difficult Tuesday. The weekly logistics — exactly what gets sent, and when — are in Section 8.

The six things that matter

1. **A regular slot most weekdays, roughly fifteen to twenty minutes.** Same place, table cleared, no screens, but it does not need to be the same time every single day or survive every single evening intact — see Section 8. The consistency is doing more work than the exact minute count.
2. **Mark it the same day from the answer sheet. Ticks and crosses only.** Circle the crosses. Do not explain, do not correct, do not re-teach. A method explained differently from the one taught in the lesson leaves the child holding two half-methods, which is worse than one whole one. Send me a photo instead and I will deal with it next session.
3. **If they are stuck and upset, stop.** Write the question number down and move on. A distressed evening costs more in December than the marks it might buy in January.
4. **Do not add extra work.** No additional worksheets, no revision apps, no practice books bought in a moment of worry. The volume in this plan is set deliberately and the retrieval schedule depends on it. Extra material dilutes the spacing and adds fatigue.
5. **A quick word if something feels off.** Not a formal weekly score — just a message if practice has stalled, if a topic is causing real upset, or if something at school has changed the picture. That is the fastest early warning signal in the whole plan.
6. **No maths on Friday 15 January.** None. The evening before an exam is for sleep and for a normal evening. Nothing learned that night will be available the next morning, and anything got wrong that night will still be in their head at nine o'clock.

Two things worth saying out loud to the child, once

- That the mock in December is expected to be unfinished, and that this is normal and planned for.
- That this exam tests work they have already met at school, not new material, and the preparation is about speed and confidence rather than about learning something hard.

How to answer “am I going to fail?”

The honest and useful answer is that the exam is testing Year 5 and Year 6 work, that we are working through it in order between now and January, and that the job between now and then is a bit of practice most days. Specific, factual, and about actions rather than outcomes. Reassurance that sounds like reassurance tends to confirm the worry rather than settle it.

SECTION 17

Exam week and exam day

The exam is Saturday 16 January. The last week is about arriving in good condition, not about last gains. Almost nothing learned in the final four days will be available on the day, and the attempt to learn it costs sleep, which will be.

DAY	WHAT HAPPENS
Sat 9 Jan	Mock 3, 50 minutes, full conditions, 9am. Marked and sent to me the same day.
Sun 10 Jan	Nothing.
Mon 11 Jan	A few minutes on the methods card. Ten questions from the error book. No new topics.
Tue 12 or Wed 13 Jan	Session 15. The final hour. Repair, the ten facts card, mixed practice, exam protocol.
Thu 14 Jan	The ten facts card, ten minutes. Nothing else. No new topics and no papers.
Fri 15 Jan	No maths at all. Bag packed in the evening. Normal bedtime, not an early one, because an unusually early bedtime produces an hour of lying awake.
Sat 16 Jan	The exam.

The bag, packed on Friday evening

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Two black pens | ☐ Protractor |
| ☐ Two sharpened pencils | ☐ Water in a clear bottle |
| ☐ Eraser and pencil sharpener | ☐ Anything named in the school's own letter |
| ☐ 30 cm ruler | ☐ No calculator, and no phone in the room |

Saturday morning

- A normal breakfast, of a normal size, containing something other than sugar.
- No maths in the car and no last questions at the gate. There is nothing to gain and a wrong answer at that point does real damage.
- Arrive with time to spare. Rushing raises the heart rate and the first five minutes of the paper are spent bringing it back down.

The first sixty seconds of the paper

1. Write the name. Every year, someone does not.
2. Turn to the end and see how long the paper is and where Section B starts. Knowing the shape stops the pacing being guesswork.
3. Start Section A. Cover the options, solve, then look.

The three rules to leave them with

1. Nothing is left blank in Section A.
2. Every Section B answer has working above it and a unit after it.
3. Stuck for fifteen seconds means star it and move on. Come back at the end.

Afterwards, do not conduct a post mortem. Ask what it was like, accept whatever answer arrives, and leave it. The paper is finished and nothing said about it on Saturday afternoon changes a mark.

The full resource index

Every source referenced anywhere in this plan, in one place. All of it is free, and all of it is intended by its publisher for exactly this kind of personal practice and printing. Nothing here was written by me — my part is the teaching, the sequencing, and the covering sheet on each week's pack.

Topic-by-topic worksheets

SOURCE	WHAT'S THERE
Corbettmaths Primary corbettmathsprimary.com/content	Around 76 primary maths topics, each with a short video, a worksheet, and an answer sheet. Covers every topic in Section 7's scheme of work: all four operations, place value, negatives, factors/multiples/primes/squares, fractions, percentages, ratio, area, perimeter, angles, symmetry, metric units, averages, charts, coordinates, sequences and substitution.
Corbettmaths Primary 5-a-day corbettmathsprimary.com/5-a-day	Short daily mixed practice at four KS2 tiers — Bronze, Silver, Gold, Platinum — organised by month. Gold and Platinum sit closest to the level this exam is pitched at. Used for light, low-stakes daily practice, not as a substitute for the topic worksheets.
Corbettmaths Times Tables corbettmathsprimary.com	Straightforward times-tables practice and self-testing. Used in the warm-up phase of most sessions and for daily facts practice at home.

Full papers: diagnostic and mocks

SOURCE	WHAT'S THERE
Key Stage 2 SATs papers gov.uk — search “national curriculum assessments past test materials”	The official Year 6 national test: Paper 1 Arithmetic (30 min, no calculator) and Papers 2–3 Reasoning (40 min each, no calculator), every year with its own official mark scheme. The three most recent years are hosted directly on gov.uk; earlier years back to 2016 are mirrored by established revision sites such as Third Space Learning. This is the diagnostic in Section 6, and Mock 2 in Section 13.
Dulwich College Year 7 Entrance & Scholarship specimen papers dulwich.org.uk, Admissions > 11 Entry	Six full specimen maths papers (A–F), published by the school for applicants, each one hour, no calculator, 100 marks, each with its own official mark scheme. The closest free match in both level and format to the exam this plan is preparing for. Used for Mock 1 and Mock 3 in Section 13.
The school's own specimen paper sent directly to applicants	Not yet available as of this revision. The single most valuable paper in the whole plan once it arrives — see Section 14.

Further practice, if more is needed

SOURCE	WHAT'S THERE
Manchester Grammar School arithmetic tests via 11plusguide.com	Non-calculator arithmetic tests from past entrance rounds, with answer sheets. Useful extra material if the daily facts practice needs a change of format.
ISEB and other independent school specimen papers via 11plusguide.com and examberrypapers.co.uk	A wide range of published 11+ specimen papers from independent schools, several with answers or mark schemes. Held in reserve as spare mock material if more than three sittings are wanted before January.

Links move occasionally, and school websites reorganise their admissions pages from time to time. If anything here has moved by the time you look for it, searching the site name plus “Year 7 entrance specimen paper” or “11 plus maths past papers” reliably finds the current location — these are all well-established, widely mirrored resources.

APPENDIX B

Methods card: the things to know cold

These are recall, not understanding. Each one should come back without hesitation, because a child working these out from first principles in a 50-minute non-calculator paper will not finish. Tested in starters throughout the term.

Number

1. Times tables to 12×12 , and the matching division facts.
2. Square numbers to 144, and their square roots.
3. Prime numbers up to 50. And that 1 is not prime.
4. Divisibility tests for 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 9 and 10.
5. Rounding: underline the digit, look at the one to its right, 5 or more rounds up.
6. Order of operations: brackets, then multiply and divide, then add and subtract.
7. Negatives: adding moves right along the number line, subtracting moves left.
8. Multiplying by 10, 100, 1,000 moves the digits one, two, three places left.
9. Fraction of an amount: divide by the bottom, multiply by the top.
10. Simplifying: divide top and bottom by the highest common factor, then check again.
11. Adding fractions: same denominator first, then add the tops only.
12. Percentages without a calculator: 50% halve, 25% quarter, 10% divide by ten, 5% half of ten per cent, 1% divide by a hundred. Build everything else from these.
13. Percentage decrease: find the percentage, then subtract it from the original.
14. The conversions: a half is 0.5 and 50%, a quarter 0.25 and 25%, three quarters 0.75 and 75%, a fifth 0.2 and 20%, a tenth 0.1 and 10%, a third about 0.33 and 33.3%.
15. Ratio: add the parts, divide the total by that number, multiply by each share.
16. Proportion: find the value for one, then scale it.

Shape

17. Perimeter is the distance round the outside. Area is the space inside.
18. Rectangle area = length $\times$ width.
19. Triangle area = half $\times$ base $\times$ perpendicular height.
20. Parallelogram area = base $\times$ perpendicular height. Never the slanted side.
21. Compound area: split it into rectangles, or subtract from the bounding rectangle.
22. Angles on a straight line add to 180 degrees.
23. Angles at a point add to 360 degrees.
24. Angles in a triangle add to 180 degrees.
25. An isosceles triangle has two equal sides and two equal base angles.
26. Metric: 10 mm in a cm, 100 cm in a m, 1,000 m in a km, 1,000 g in a kg, 1,000 ml in a litre.
27. Area is measured in squared units. Perimeter is not.

Algebra, data and technique

Algebra

- !8. Coordinates are (x, y): along first, then up or down.
- !9. Quadrant signs: upper right both positive, upper left x negative, lower left both negative, lower right y negative.
- !0. Sequence rule: find the difference between consecutive terms, and check it across three gaps, not one.
- !1. Substituting: replace the letter with the number, then obey the order of operations.
- !2. Inverse operations: undo the operations in reverse order.

Handling data

- !3. Mean = total divided by how many there are.
- !4. Median = order the list first, then take the middle.
- !5. With an even number of values, the median is the mean of the middle two.
- !6. Mode = the most common value. There may be none, and there may be two.
- !7. Range = largest minus smallest. It is a difference, not a value from the list.
- !8. Pie chart: the fraction of the circle multiplied by the total. Or 360 divided by the total gives the degrees for one item.

Technique

- !9. In Section A: cover the options, solve, then look.
- !0. Nothing is left blank in Section A.
- !1. In Section B: working above the answer, unit after it.
- !2. Stuck for fifteen seconds: star it and move on.

The ten facts card. In Session 14, pick the ten items from this list that are still not automatic and write them on a single index card. That card, and nothing else, is what gets reviewed on Monday 11 January and Thursday 14 January. Ten is the limit. A revision list of forty-two items in the final week is a list that gets read rather than learned.

APPENDIX C

Progress tracker

One line a week, filled in at the end of each session. This is for me to keep the term honest, not a score to chase — there is no daily number in here, because there is no daily test.

WK	DATE	TOPIC TAUGHT	WORKSHEET(S) SENT	PRACTICE THIS WEEK	NEW ERRORS	NOTES
1	21 Sep	Diagnostic				
2	28 Sep	Written methods				
3	5 Oct	Place value, negatives				
4	12 Oct	Factors, primes, squares				
5	19 Oct	Fractions				
6	26 Oct	Percentages				
7	2 Nov	Ratio · timed practice				
8	9 Nov	Area and perimeter				
9	16 Nov	Angles, symmetry, units				
10	23 Nov	Averages · timed practice				
11	30 Nov	Charts and graphs				
12	7 Dec	Algebra				
13	14 Dec	Mock 1				
·	29 Dec	Mock 2 at home				
14	4 Jan	Repair and MCQ practice				
·	9 Jan	Mock 3 at home				
15	12 Jan	Final session				

Mock record

MOCK	MARK	UNATTEMPTED	MARKS LOST TO SLIPS	TOP REPAIR ITEM
Specimen				
Mock 1, 14 Dec				
Mock 2, 29 Dec				
Mock 3, 9 Jan				

Three signals worth watching

- **Practice thinning out for two weeks running.** The slot is not working, or the child has quietly gone off it. Worth a direct word with Mum rather than pushing harder from my side.
- **The same error category recurring in the error book.** See Section 9 — a repeated category means the fix needs to change, not just be repeated.
- **Unattempted questions not falling between mocks.** Pacing is not improving. Give Section 12's technique more room in Session 14.

What I need before Session 1

Documents

- ☐ The most recent school report, the maths section, including any teacher comment and any level or band given.
- ☐ The child's current maths exercise book, or clear photographs of two recent pages, including one with corrections on it. The corrections are more informative than the ticks.
- ☐ The specimen paper, the moment it arrives. If it has not arrived by the end of October, ask the school for it.
- ☐ The school's own letter confirming the exam date, start time and location.
- ☐ Confirmation of whether extra time or any other access arrangement has been applied for or granted. If the child has a diagnosis or a school plan, this needs applying for now rather than in December.
- ☐ Dates of any other entrance exams the child is sitting, so the schedule can account for them.
- ☐ Details of any other tutoring or extra maths already happening, and with whom. Two tutors teaching two methods is worse than one.

Questions for the parent, answered before or at Session 1

1. What does the child say about maths when nobody is trying to encourage them?
2. Has anything gone wrong in maths recently? A test, a change of set, a change of teacher, a comment from someone. Recent history explains a lot of what a diagnostic shows.
3. Which topics or question types does the child avoid, put off or get upset by?
4. How do they respond to being timed? Some children speed up and some freeze, and the plan is paced differently for each.
5. What has the child actually been told about this exam and why it matters? I need to know what they are carrying before I add anything to it.
6. What time of day can practice most reliably happen, from next week until January?

What you get back

Within 48 hours of Session 1: the strand grid filled in, the arithmetic paper result, the revised order of Sessions 2 to 12 with any reasons for the changes, and the first week's home practice. If the diagnostic shows anything that materially changes the picture, such as a fluency score low enough to reshape the term, I will say so plainly rather than absorb it quietly into the schedule.

The honest position, as of today

Sixteen weeks, fifteen hours of tuition and roughly twenty-six hours of home practice is a substantial amount of preparation for a paper pitched at levels 4 and 5. The content is not the difficulty. What decides the outcome is arithmetic fluency without a calculator, finishing within fifty minutes, and whether the twenty minutes a day actually happens. The first of those the lessons can build. The second the mocks can train. The third is the one thing in this plan that is outside my control, and it is the one that matters most.